PRATHAM BOOKS

ಅಜ್ಜಿಯ ಕಥೆಗಳು

Ajjiya Kathegalu (Grandmother's Stories)

Collected by Vasanthi Kulkarni

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Arivu Kendra sample edition · Government of Karnataka

Contents

1. ಹಾವೇರಿಯ ಕಥೆಗಳು 3
2. ಚಾಮರಾಜನಗರದ ಕಥೆಗಳು 14
3. ಉಡುಪಿಯ ಕಥೆಗಳು 26
4. ಪ್ರಶ್ನೆಗಳು 37

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CHAPTER 1

ಹಾವೇರಿಯ ಕಥೆಗಳು

Twelve folk tales from across Karnataka, collected from grandmothers in Haveri, Chamarajanagar and Udupi and written down for the first time. Each story ends with a question to ask the person who told it to you.

The morning began the way most mornings in the village did: with the temple bell carried across the fields, the smell of woodsmoke from the first kitchen fires, and the crows arguing on the tamarind tree about who had slept where. Nobody paid the crows much attention, except for one small person who was already awake and already wondering.

Ajji said that stories were like water. You could not hold them in your hands, but you could carry them in a pot, and if you were careful you could pour a little for everyone who came to the door. She said this while shelling peas, which was how she said most of the important things.

There is a road that goes out of the village past the pump house and the broken cart, and if you follow it far enough it turns into a path, and the path turns into a track between two fields, and the track ends at a stone where the hill begins. Everyone knows the stone. Not everyone has sat on it.

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CHAPTER 4

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